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SAFER
FEDERALWORKFORCE

MENU

Testing

NEW Q: Can an agency establish a testing program utilizing a third party?

A: Agencies must establish a testing program. In lieu of conducting testing onsite, agencies can require Federal employees and onsite contractors who are not fully vaccinated or who decline to attest to their vaccination status to provide proof of a timely negative COVID-19 test.

Find COVID-19
Vaccines Near You

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For questions or comments, email the Safer Federal Workforce Task Force at SaferFederalWorkforce@gsa.gov



Testing

NEW Q: Are agencies required to establish a screening testing program for SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19?

A: Agencies must establish a screening testing program for SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19, to test federal employees and contractor employees who work onsite and who are not fully vaccinated or who have declined to provide their vaccination information. Enrollment in this testing program is mandatory for those individuals and they must be tested at least once a week. Screening tests are intended to identify asymptomatic or presymptomatic infected individuals without known or suspected exposure to SARS-CoV-2. Both federal employees and contractor employees who are fully vaccinated generally do not need to undergo screening testing.

Agencies may satisfy the requirement to establish a screening testing program in a variety of ways, including through in-house capabilities, a contract with one or more third party testing provider(s), an interagency agreement with another agency that has testing capabilities, or a multi-agency contract.

NEW Q: What steps may an agency take if a federal employee refuses to take a test?

A: Refusals to take a test may result in disciplinary measures. In addition to pursuing any disciplinary action, an agency may separately elect to bar the employee from the agency workplace for the safety of others pending resolution of any disciplinary or other action the agency may pursue. Any decision to bar the employee should occur in consultation with the agency's onsite security authority, agency's human resources office, and agency's legal counsel. If the agency bars the employee from the workplace, and the nature of the employee's work does not allow for it to be performed outside of the workplace, the employee must be placed on paid administrative leave until the question of disciplinary action is resolved. In pursuing an adverse action, the agency must also follow normal processes to provide the required notice to the employee.

However, if an employee raises a disability or religious issue as the reason for not being tested, an agency should follow its process to review and consider what, if any, reasonable accommodation should be offered. All agency personnel designated to receive requests for disability

accommodations should also know how to handle requests consistent with other federal employment nondiscrimination laws that may apply—for instance, with respect to religious accommodations. While the request is being resolved, the agency may bar the employee from official worksites. During that temporary period, the agency may direct the employee to work from home. If the employee’s duties cannot be performed via telework, the employee should be granted administrative leave.

If the employee’s request for an accommodation is denied, and the employee does not comply with the testing requirement, the agency may pursue disciplinary action.

NEW Q: Are agencies required to pay for the cost of testing employees pursuant to their screening testing program?

A: Yes, agencies are required to pay for the cost of testing federal employees pursuant to their screening testing program. Agencies are also responsible for paying the cost of testing should an employee visit another federal agency if the employee’s agency has approved the visit in advance.

NEW Q: What types of test may an agency utilize for its testing program?

A: Agencies may utilize any COVID-19 viral test, such as a PCR or antigen test, that has been [authorized by the Food and Drug Administration](#) to detect current infection. Any test that an agency utilizes must include a report that documents the test result and can be provided to the federal employee or contractor employee who was tested, the agency, or both. If the results are provided to the federal employee or contractor employee who was tested, the agency must establish a means for the federal employee or contractor employee to provide those results to the appropriate agency staff for verification that required testing has been completed. If the results are provided directly to the employer, the report should be provided in compliance with regulations implementing the Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act of 1996 (HIPAA), as amended.

NEW Q: Can agencies utilize pooled specimen testing in their testing program?

A: Yes, agencies can utilize pooled specimen testing, assuming the testing program utilizes any COVID-19 viral test that is used to detect current infection and has been [authorized by the Food and Drug Administration](#), and provides results to the employee, the agency, or both. Pooled specimen testing combines the same type of specimen from several people and conducts one test on the combined specimen. If the pooled specimen test returns a positive result, each specimen in the pool must be retested individually.

NEW Q: Does the testing requirement apply to not fully vaccinated federal employees and contractor employees who are not reporting to their worksite (e.g., are on maximum telework or working remotely)?

A: No, only those federal employees and contractor employees who are not fully vaccinated or decline to provide their vaccination status and who work onsite are required to undergo regular testing.

If an employee who is not fully vaccinated or declines to provide their vaccination status does not report to a worksite during a particular week (e.g., due to taking leave or teleworking), they do not need to be tested that week.

NEW Q: Can an agency require a federal employee who is not fully vaccinated or who has declined to provide their vaccination information to work remotely or telework, solely on the basis of their vaccination status and in lieu of entering that individual into a testing program?

A: No, an agency may not require a federal employee who is not fully vaccinated to work from home based solely on their vaccination status.

NEW Q: Does the testing requirement apply to federal employees and onsite contractor employees who only work onsite on an infrequent basis?

A: Federal employees and contractor employees who are not fully vaccinated or who have declined to provide their vaccination information and who work onsite on an infrequent basis must be tested at least once in any week that they are working onsite.

NEW Q: Should agencies allow employees to undertake required testing on duty time?

A: Yes. When a federal employee is required to be tested pursuant to an agency's testing program, the time the employee spends obtaining the test (including travel time) from a site preapproved by the agency is duty time; thus, there is no need for the employee to take administrative leave for such time during the employee's basic tour of duty. An agency should only authorize an employee to spend time obtaining a test during the employee's basic tour of duty hours and only for the amount of time necessary to obtain the test. In most circumstances, agencies should authorize employees to take no more than one hour to travel to the testing site, complete testing, and return to work. Agencies should require employees taking longer than one hour to document the reasons for the additional time. If, due to unforeseen circumstances, the employee is unable to obtain the test during basic tour of duty hours, the normal overtime hours of work rules apply.

Reasonable travel costs that are incurred as a result of obtaining the test from a site preapproved by the agency should be handled the same way as local travel or temporary duty (TDY) cost reimbursement is handled based on agency policy.

When an employee is not required to be tested but decides to obtain a COVID-19 test during basic tour of duty hours at the employee's own initiative, the employee may request sick leave or other

available paid time off for that situation.

NEW Q: Are federal employees and contractor employees participating in an agency testing program limited in their ability to work onsite in between weekly tests?

A: No, provided that they have met any applicable testing requirement and have not tested positive for COVID-19, federal employees and contractor employees participating in an agency testing program are not limited in their ability to work onsite between weekly tests, although they must comply with all relevant safety protocols for not fully vaccinated individuals. However, if the employee or contractor employee has come into close contact with a person with COVID-19 during this time, they should follow CDC guidelines for testing and quarantine and not enter a worksite. Similarly, if they have symptoms consistent with COVID-19, they should not enter a worksite.

Agencies should develop a procedure for addressing circumstances in which employees or onsite contractor employees miss their regular testing requirement, which may include restricting the individual's access to worksites if they have not obtained a test within a period of time specified by the agency.

An employee's failure to comply with testing requirements can result in discipline, including an adverse action. An agency may separately elect to bar the employee from the agency workplace for the safety of others pending resolution of any disciplinary action. A contractor employee's failure to comply with testing requirements can have consequences such as removal from the contract for the convenience of the Government.

NEW Q: What steps should an agency consider in determining the frequency of required testing for employees and onsite contractor employees in specific workplaces?

A: Federal employees and contractor employees who work onsite and who are not fully vaccinated or who have declined to provide their vaccination information must be tested at least once a week. As set forth by the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention in its [testing guidance for federal workers](#), agencies should consider workplace characteristics, availability of testing, cost, and level of community transmission, among other factors in determining the frequency of required testing for federal employees and onsite contractor employees. Agencies may have different testing frequency for employees with different job responsibilities or worksites. Generally, agencies should not need to test federal employees and onsite contractor employees more than twice a week.

NEW Q: Can information on employee and contractor employee test results be stored by an agency? How must information on test results be stored? How long must the information be stored for and who may have access to it?

A: Agencies have unique operational environments and may develop their own processes to document COVID-19 test results in compliance with all applicable laws and in accordance with their agency's records management policies.

The Privacy Act statement for the testing requirements will refer to the Government-wide system of records (OPM/GOVT-10) for employee medical files (EMFs), which is governed by OPM regulations (5 C.F.R. part 293, subpart E). Under those rules, each agency must have written instructions for its EMF system with appropriate safeguards, and must retain short-term medical records under the applicable record schedule. Agencies with positions that are not subject to OPM's regulations or that are not subject to OPM/GOVT-10 must give their employees an alternative Privacy Act statement. Any COVID-19 related certification or vaccination information must be maintained separately from the Official Personnel Folder. The Rehabilitation Act also requires that test results be kept confidential and limits who may have access to such information. Agencies are encouraged to take steps to promote privacy and IT security, while also providing the relevant information to agency officials who need to know in order to implement the safety protocols.

Agencies should consult, as appropriate, with their Agency Records Officer, Chief Information Officer, Chief Medical Officer, Senior Agency Official for Privacy, and agency legal counsel to determine appropriate information management protocols.

NEW Q: Are agencies required to provide testing for work-related exposures?

A: Federal employees who have been exposed to persons with COVID-19 at work should receive diagnostic testing. Agencies that have in-house capabilities (either through an occupational health clinic or through the utilization of contract options) can provide testing at the worksite; if an agency does not provide testing at the worksite, it should determine a process for employee diagnostic testing.

NEW Q: Can an employee get reimbursed for costs related to testing if required for official travel?

A: Yes, the cost of testing for current infection with SARS-CoV-2, required for official travel and not available through a federal dispensary or not covered (or reimbursable) through travel insurance, can be claimed in a travel voucher as a Miscellaneous Expense under agency travel policies.

NEW Q: Does the employee have a responsibility to pay for their own testing if the exposure is not work-related?

A: An agency is not responsible for providing testing to an individual as a result of a potential exposure that is not work-related. If the employee or contractor employee has come into close

contact with a person with COVID-19 outside of work, they should follow CDC guidelines for testing and quarantine and not enter a worksite.

NEW Q: If an employee tests positive for SARS-CoV-2 infection, is the agency required to record the COVID-19 case on the OSHA Injury and Illness Log?

A: Under OSHA's recordkeeping requirements, if an employee tests positive for SARS-CoV-2 infection, the case must be recorded on the OSHA Illness and Injury Log if each of the following conditions are met: (1) the case is a confirmed case of COVID-19; (2) the case is work-related (as defined by 29 CFR 1904.5); and (3) the case involves one or more relevant recording criteria (set forth in 29 CFR 1904.7) (e.g., medical treatment beyond first aid, days away from work). Employers should also follow state and county reporting requirements and comply with state and county contact tracing efforts.

NEW Q: Should agencies discuss testing plans with their employee unions?

A: Since agencies need to act quickly due to the COVID-19 emergency and to protect the health and safety of onsite employees, contractor employees, and visitors, agencies should engage with employee unions at their earliest opportunity as they develop agency-specific testing plans and otherwise satisfy any applicable collective bargaining obligations under the law at the earliest opportunity, including on a post-implementation basis where appropriate.

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Testing

Q: Are agencies required to establish a screening testing program for SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19?

A: No, though an agency may decide to establish its own screening testing program.

Q: If an agency decides to establish a screening testing program, what steps may it take if a federal employee refuses to take a COVID-19 test required pursuant to that program?

A: Refusals to take a required test may result in disciplinary measures. In addition to pursuing any disciplinary action, an agency may separately elect to bar the employee from the agency workplace for the safety of others pending resolution of any disciplinary or other action the agency may pursue. Any decision to bar the employee should occur in consultation with the agency's onsite security authority, agency's human resources office, and agency's legal counsel. If the agency bars the employee from the workplace, and the nature of the employee's work does not allow for it to be performed outside of the workplace, the employee must be placed on paid administrative leave until the question of disciplinary action is resolved. In pursuing an adverse action, the agency must also follow normal processes to provide the required notice to the employee.

An agency follows a different process if the employee seeks a reasonable accommodation. In that case, an agency should follow its ordinary process to review and consider what, if any, reasonable accommodation should be offered. All agency personnel designated to receive requests for disability accommodations should also know how to handle requests consistent with other federal employment nondiscrimination laws that may apply. While the request is being resolved, the agency may bar the employee from official worksites. During that temporary period, the agency may direct the employee to work from home. If the employee's duties cannot be performed via telework, the employee should be granted administrative leave.

If the employee's request for an accommodation is denied, and the employee does not comply with a testing requirement, the agency may pursue disciplinary action.

Q: Are agencies required to pay for the cost of testing employees pursuant to a screening testing program?

A: Yes, agencies that establish a screening testing program are required to pay for the cost of testing federal employees pursuant to that program. Agencies are also responsible for paying the cost of testing should an employee visit another federal agency if the employee's agency has approved the visit in advance.

Q: What types of test may an agency utilize for a screening testing program?

A: Agencies may utilize any COVID-19 viral test, such as a PCR or antigen test, that has been [authorized by the Food and Drug Administration](#) to detect current infection. If the results are provided to the federal employee or contractor employee who was tested, the agency must establish a means for the federal employee or contractor employee to provide those results to the appropriate agency staff for verification that required testing has been completed. If the results are provided directly to the employer, the report should be provided in compliance with regulations implementing the Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act of 1996 (HIPAA), as amended.

Q: Can agencies utilize pooled specimen testing in a testing program?

A: Yes, agencies can utilize pooled specimen testing, assuming the testing program utilizes any COVID-19 viral test that is used to detect current infection and has been [authorized by the Food and Drug Administration](#). Pooled specimen testing combines the same type of specimen from several people and conducts one test on the combined specimen. If the pooled specimen test returns a positive result, each specimen in the pool must be retested individually.

Q: Should agencies allow employees to undertake any required testing on duty time?

A: Yes. When a federal employee is required to be tested pursuant to an agency's testing program, the time the employee spends obtaining the test (including travel time) from a site preapproved by the agency is duty time; thus, there is no need for the employee to take administrative leave for such time during the employee's basic tour of duty. An agency should only authorize an employee to spend time obtaining a test during the employee's basic tour of duty hours and only for the amount of time necessary to obtain the test. In most circumstances, agencies should authorize employees to take no more than one hour to travel to the testing site, complete testing, and return to work. Agencies should require employees taking longer than one hour to document the reasons for the additional time. If, due to unforeseen circumstances, the employee is unable to obtain the test during basic tour of duty hours, the normal overtime hours of work rules apply.

Reasonable travel costs that are incurred as a result of obtaining the test from a site preapproved by the agency should be handled the same way as local travel or temporary duty (TDY) cost

reimbursement is handled based on agency policy and the Federal Travel Regulation.

When an employee is not required to be tested but decides to obtain a COVID-19 test during basic tour of duty hours at the employee's own initiative, the employee may request sick leave or other available paid time off for that situation.

Q: Are federal employees and contractor employees participating in an agency testing program limited in their ability to work onsite in between tests?

A: No, provided that they have met any applicable testing requirement and have not tested positive for COVID-19, federal employees and contractor employees participating in an agency testing program are not limited in their ability to work onsite between tests, although they must comply with all relevant safety protocols. However, if the employee or contractor employee has come into close contact with a person with COVID-19 during this time, they should follow CDC guidelines for testing and quarantine and not enter a worksite. Similarly, if they have symptoms consistent with COVID-19, they should not enter a worksite.

Agencies should develop a procedure for addressing circumstances in which employees or onsite contractor employees miss their required test, which may include restricting the individual's access to worksites if they have not obtained a test within a period of time specified by the agency.

An employee's failure to comply with testing requirements can result in discipline, including an adverse action. An agency may separately elect to bar the employee from the agency workplace for the safety of others pending resolution of any disciplinary action. A contractor employee's failure to comply with testing requirements may result in that individual being denied entry to a federal building. Such circumstances do not relieve the contractor from meeting all contractual requirements.

Q: Can information on employee test results be stored by an agency? How must information on test results be stored? How long must the information be stored for and who may have access to it?

A: Agencies have unique operational environments and may develop their own processes to document COVID-19 test results in compliance with all applicable laws and in accordance with their agency's records management policies.

The Privacy Act statement for the testing requirements will refer to the Government-wide system of records (OPM/GOVT-10) for employee medical files (EMFs), which is governed by OPM regulations (5 C.F.R. part 293, subpart E). Under those rules, each agency must have written instructions for its EMF system with appropriate safeguards, and must retain short-term medical records under the applicable record schedule. Agencies with positions that are not subject to OPM's regulations or that

are not subject to OPM/GOVT-10 must give their employees an alternative Privacy Act statement. Any COVID-19 related certification or vaccination information must be maintained separately from the Official Personnel Folder. The Rehabilitation Act also requires that test results be kept confidential and limits who may have access to such information. Agencies are encouraged to take steps to promote privacy and IT security, while also providing the relevant information to agency officials who need to know in order to implement the safety protocols.

Agencies should consult, as appropriate, with their Agency Records Officer, Chief Information Officer, Chief Medical Officer, Senior Agency Official for Privacy, and agency legal counsel to determine appropriate information management protocols.

Q: Are agencies required to provide testing for work-related exposures?

A: Federal employees who have been exposed to persons with COVID-19 at work should receive diagnostic testing at no cost to the employee. Agencies that have in-house capabilities (either through an occupational health clinic or through the utilization of contract options) can provide testing at the worksite; if an agency does not provide testing at the worksite, it should determine a process for employee diagnostic testing.

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A: Yes, the cost of testing for current infection with SARS-CoV-2, required for official travel and not available through a federal dispensary or not covered (or reimbursable) through travel insurance, can be claimed in a travel voucher as a Miscellaneous Expense under agency travel policies.

Q: Does the employee have a responsibility to pay for their own testing if the exposure is not work-related?

A: An agency is not responsible for providing testing to an individual as a result of a potential exposure that is not work-related. If the employee or contractor employee has come into close contact with a person with COVID-19 outside of work, they should follow CDC guidelines for testing and quarantine and not enter a worksite.

Q: If an employee tests positive for SARS-CoV-2 infection, is the agency required to record the COVID-19 case on the OSHA Injury and Illness Log?

A: Under OSHA's recordkeeping requirements, if an employee tests positive for SARS-CoV-2 infection, the case must be recorded on the OSHA Illness and Injury Log if each of the following conditions are met: (1) the case is a confirmed case of COVID-19; (2) the case is work-related (as defined by 29 CFR 1904.5); and (3) the case involves one or more relevant recording criteria (set forth in 29 CFR 1904.7)

(e.g., medical treatment beyond first aid, days away from work). Employers should also follow state and county reporting requirements and comply with state and county contact tracing efforts.

Q: Should agencies discuss any testing plans with their employee unions?

A: Agencies should engage with employee unions at their earliest opportunity as they develop any agency-specific testing plans and otherwise satisfy any applicable collective bargaining obligations under the law at the earliest opportunity, including on a post-implementation basis where appropriate.



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A: No, provided that they have met any applicable testing requirement and have not tested positive for COVID-19, federal employees and contractor employees participating in an agency testing program are not limited in their ability to work onsite between tests, although they must comply with all relevant safety protocols. However, if the employee or contractor employee has come into close contact with a person with COVID-19 during this time, they should follow CDC guidelines for testing and quarantine and not enter a worksite. Similarly, if they have symptoms consistent with COVID-19, they should not enter a worksite.

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are not subject to OPM/GOVT-10 must give their employees an alternative Privacy Act statement. Any COVID-19 related certification or vaccination information must be maintained separately from the Official Personnel Folder. The Rehabilitation Act also requires that test results be kept confidential and limits who may have access to such information. Agencies are encouraged to take steps to promote privacy and IT security, while also providing the relevant information to agency officials who need to know in order to implement the safety protocols.

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Q: Does the employee have a responsibility to pay for their own testing if the exposure is not work-related?

A: An agency is not responsible for providing testing to an individual as a result of a potential exposure that is not work-related. If the employee or contractor employee has come into close contact with a person with COVID-19 outside of work, they should follow CDC guidelines for testing and quarantine and not enter a worksite.

Q: If an employee tests positive for SARS-CoV-2 infection, is the agency required to record the COVID-19 case on the OSHA Injury and Illness Log?

A: Under OSHA's recordkeeping requirements, if an employee tests positive for SARS-CoV-2 infection, the case must be recorded on the OSHA Illness and Injury Log if each of the following conditions are met: (1) the case is a confirmed case of COVID-19; (2) the case is work-related (as defined by 29 CFR 1904.5); and (3) the case involves one or more relevant recording criteria (set forth in 29 CFR 1904.7)

(e.g., medical treatment beyond first aid, days away from work). Employers should also follow state and county reporting requirements and comply with state and county contact tracing efforts.

Q: Should agencies discuss any testing plans with their employee unions?

A: Agencies should engage with employee unions at their earliest opportunity as they develop any agency-specific testing plans and otherwise satisfy any applicable collective bargaining obligations under the law at the earliest opportunity, including on a post-implementation basis where appropriate.

NEW Q: When should a fully vaccinated employee or onsite contractor employee be tested after a close contact with someone with suspected or confirmed COVID-19?

A: Individuals who have been fully vaccinated and have had close contact with someone with suspected or confirmed COVID-19 should get tested 5-7 days after exposure, even if they do not have symptoms. They should also wear a mask indoors in public for 14 days following exposure or until their test result is negative. If their test result is positive, they should isolate for 10 days.



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Testing

Screening Testing **NEW AND UPDATED**

NEW Q: What is screening testing?

A: [Screening tests](#) are intended to identify infection with SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19, in unvaccinated people who are asymptomatic and do not have known, suspected, or reported exposure to SARS-CoV-2. Screening helps to identify unknown cases so that measures can be taken to prevent further transmission. Screening testing is separate and distinct from diagnostic testing, which should be performed on anyone that has signs and symptoms consistent with COVID-19 or following recent known or suspected exposure to SARS-CoV-2.

UPDATED Q: Should agencies establish a screening testing program for SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19?

A: Yes, agencies should establish a COVID-19 screening testing program by February 15, 2022 for employees who are not fully vaccinated, including due to a pending or approved request for exception or extension from the COVID-19 vaccination requirement for Federal employees. If an agency is engaged in enforcement steps with an employee covered by the vaccination requirement who is not fully vaccinated and who does not have a pending or approved exception or extension request, those employees should also be included in the agency's screening testing program.

An agency generally does not need to include onsite contractor employees or fully vaccinated employees in its screening testing program. For certain roles, functions, or work environments, an agency may determine that it is necessary that certain onsite contractor employees, certain employees regardless of their vaccination status, or certain employees and certain onsite contractor employees regardless of their vaccination status must participate in screening testing, given operational or administrative considerations associated with conducting screening testing for those roles, functions, or work environments.

NEW Q: What testing protocols should be applied through an agency's screening testing program to employees who are not fully vaccinated?

A: Employees who are not fully vaccinated and who work onsite should undergo regular screening testing through their agency's screening testing program. This includes employees who do not work at a Federal facility but who interact in person with members of the public as part of their job duties, such as safety inspectors.

For purposes of regularly testing these employees through a screening testing program, an employee enrolled in the program should be tested weekly for any week during which they work onsite or interact in person with members of the public as part of their job duties. Agencies may require more frequent testing, such as for certain roles, functions, or work environments. Testing may be conducted at a Federal facility or offsite as determined by the agency. The test should not be both self-administered and self-read by the employee unless observed by the agency or an authorized telehealth provider.

NEW Q: Do Federal employees or contractor employees participating in an agency screening testing program need to be able to provide the results of a negative test in order to enter or be present in a Federal facility?

Federal employees participating in an agency screening testing program do not need to be able to provide the results of a negative test each time they enter or are present in their agency's facilities, unless required as part of the agency's screening testing program and workplace safety protocols. That said, Federal employees generally are treated as visitors during a visit to another agency, so while they are onsite at *another* agency's worksite, they should be able to show proof of a negative COVID-19 test result administered within the past 3 days, if they are not fully vaccinated or decline to provide their vaccination information to the host agency.

Similarly, contractor employees participating in an agency testing program do not need to be able to provide the results of a negative test each time they enter or are present at that agency's facilities, unless required as part of the agency's testing program and workplace safety protocols. However, if they are visiting *another* agency's facilities, they should be able to show proof of a negative COVID-19 test result administered within the past 3 days, if they are not fully vaccinated or decline to provide their vaccination information to the host agency.

NEW Q: Do the screening testing protocols apply to employees who are not fully vaccinated and who are not reporting to their worksite (e.g., are on maximum telework, working remotely, or on leave)?

A: No, employees who are working remotely or who are on maximum telework do not need to undergo regular testing. An employee who does not report to a worksite or interact in person with members of the public as part of their job duties during a particular week (e.g., due to taking leave, teleworking, or working remotely) does not need to be tested that week.

Should these employees have a one-time need to report to one of their agency's facilities, they should be tested in the week they are entering the facility. Should these employees need to be onsite at another agency's facility, they generally would be treated as visitors during their visit, and so should be able to show proof of a negative COVID-19 test result administered within the past 3 days.

NEW Q: Do the screening testing protocols apply to Federal employees who are not fully vaccinated and who only work onsite on an infrequent basis?

A: Federal employees who are not fully vaccinated and who work onsite or interact in person with members of the public as part of their job duties on an infrequent basis should be tested at least once in the week that they are working onsite or interact in person with members of the public as part of their job duties. An agency may determine that some employees who generally do not report to a worksite or interact with members of the public as part of their job duties, but may need to do so on an emergency basis (e.g., for accident investigations or disaster response) are required to undergo regular testing on a frequency determined by the agency.

Should these Federal employees need to be onsite at another agency's facility, they generally would be treated as visitors during their visit, and so would need to be able to show proof of a negative COVID-19 test result administered within the past 3 days.

UPDATED Q: What types of tests may an agency utilize for a screening testing program?

A: For screening testing programs, agencies may utilize any viral tests [authorized by the Food and Drug Administration](#) (FDA) to detect current infection. There are two types of [viral tests](#): [antigen tests](#) and [nucleic acid application tests \(NAATs\)](#). Reverse transcriptase polymerase chain reaction (RT-PCR) tests are a type of NAAT. Agencies should consult [FDA guidance](#) for specific authorized tests impacted by COVID-19 variants and the current status on recommended use.

Options for testing methods include: (1) in-store or drive-through point-of-care (POC) testing, such as at pharmacies, (2) swab-testing capabilities that enable an individual to collect the specimen—using a self-collection kit—and drop it off at a designated collection location or ship it to a laboratory, (3) over-the-counter (OTC) tests, as long as those tests are not both self-

administered and self-read by the employee unless observed by the agency or an authorized telehealth provider, or (4) other self-administered tests, as long as those tests are not also self-read by the employee unless observed by the agency or an authorized telehealth provider.

Agencies should establish a means of verifying the date and result of a test—the test should not be both self-administered and self-read by the employee unless observed by the agency or an authorized onsite or telehealth provider. If the results are provided to the Federal employee or contractor employee who was tested, the agency should establish a means for the Federal employee or contractor employee to provide those results to the appropriate agency staff for verification that required testing has been completed and the employee has tested negative. Agencies must comply with applicable privacy safeguards and regulations when receiving test results.

UPDATED Q: What steps may an agency take if a Federal employee refuses to take a COVID-19 test required pursuant to that program?

A: Refusals to take a required test or to provide the results of the test may result in disciplinary measures. In addition to pursuing any disciplinary action, an agency may separately elect to bar the employee from the agency workplace for the safety of others pending resolution of any disciplinary or other action the agency may pursue. Any decision to bar the employee should occur in consultation with the agency's onsite security authority, agency's human resources office, and agency's legal counsel. If the agency bars the employee from the workplace, and the nature of the employee's work does not allow for it to be performed outside of the workplace, the employee must be placed on paid administrative leave until the question of disciplinary action is resolved. In pursuing an adverse action, the agency must also follow normal processes to provide the required notice to the employee.

An agency follows a different process if the employee seeks an accommodation from the requirement to be regularly tested. In that case, an agency should follow its ordinary process to review and consider what, if any, accommodation should be offered in accordance with Federal employment nondiscrimination laws. All agency personnel designated to receive requests for disability accommodations should also know how to handle requests consistent with other Federal employment nondiscrimination laws that may apply. While the request is being resolved, the agency may bar the employee from official worksites. During that temporary period, the agency may direct the employee to work from home. If the employee's duties cannot be performed via telework, the employee should be granted administrative leave for the temporary period of time while the request is being resolved.

If the employee's request for an accommodation to a testing requirement is denied, and the employee does not comply with the testing requirement, the agency may pursue disciplinary

action up to and including removal.

UPDATED Q: Are agencies required to pay for the cost of testing employees pursuant to a screening testing program?

A: Yes, agencies are required to pay for the cost of screening testing of Federal employees pursuant to the agency's screening testing program. Agencies are also responsible for paying the cost of required testing should an employee visit another Federal agency if the employee's agency has approved the visit in advance. Agencies can either pay for the testing directly or reimburse employees for required tests. Should agencies have questions regarding their approach to funding this testing from agency appropriations, they should contact their respective OMB Resource Management Office.

UPDATED Q: Can agencies utilize pooled specimen testing in a screening testing program?

A: Yes, agencies can utilize [pooled specimen testing](#), assuming the screening testing program utilizes any COVID-19 viral test that is used to detect current infection and has been [authorized by the Food and Drug Administration](#) for use in pooled testing. Agencies should consult [FDA guidance](#) for specific authorized tests impacted by COVID-19 variants and the current status on recommended use.

Pooled specimen testing combines the same type of specimen from several people and conducts one NAAT laboratory test on the combined specimen. If the pooled specimen test returns a positive result, each specimen in the pool must be retested individually. Of note, as the incidence of COVID-19 increases among the population being tested, the cost savings of a pooling strategy decreases because more pooled tests will return positive results, and those specimens will need to be retested individually to determine which individual(s) are positive.

UPDATED Q: Is required screening testing undertaken on duty time?

A: Yes. When a Federal employee is required to be tested pursuant to an agency's screening testing program, the time the employee spends obtaining the test (including travel time) from a site preapproved by the agency is duty time; thus, there is no need for the employee to take administrative leave for such time during the employee's basic tour of duty. An agency should only authorize an employee to spend time related to screening testing during the employee's basic tour of duty hours and only for the amount of time necessary. Agencies should determine the amount of time to authorize employees to take to travel to the testing site (if travel is required), complete testing, and return to work. Agencies should require employees taking longer than that amount of time to document the reasons for the additional time. If, due to

unforeseen circumstances, the employee is unable to obtain the test during basic tour of duty hours, the normal overtime hours of work rules apply.

Reasonable travel costs that are incurred as a result of obtaining the test from a site preapproved by the agency should be handled the same way as local travel or temporary duty (TDY) cost reimbursement is handled based on agency policy and the Federal Travel Regulation.

When an employee is not required to be tested but decides to obtain a COVID-19 test during basic tour of duty hours at the employee's own initiative, the employee may request sick leave or other available paid time off for that situation.

UPDATED Q: Are Federal employees and contractor employees participating in an agency screening testing program limited in their ability to work onsite in between tests?

A: No, provided that they have met any applicable testing requirement and have not tested positive for COVID-19, Federal employees and contractor employees participating in an agency screening testing program are not limited in their ability to work onsite between tests, although they should comply with all relevant safety protocols. However, if the employee or contractor employee has come into [close contact](#) with a person with COVID-19 during this time, they should follow CDC guidelines for testing and quarantine, as well as any other requirements set forth in agency workplace safety protocols. Similarly, if they have symptoms consistent with COVID-19, they should follow agency protocols and not enter a worksite.

Agencies should develop a procedure for addressing circumstances in which employees or onsite contractor employees miss their required test, which may include restricting the individual's access to worksites if they have not obtained a test within a period of time specified by the agency.

An employee's failure to comply with testing requirements can result in disciplinary action, up to and including removal. An agency may separately elect to bar the employee from the agency workplace for the safety of others pending resolution of any disciplinary action. A contractor employee's failure to comply with testing requirements may result in that individual being denied entry to a Federal facility. Such circumstances do not relieve the contractor from meeting all contractual requirements.

Diagnostic Testing NEW AND UPDATED

Testing Results and Information UPDATED

Testing and Labor Relations

Find COVID-19
Vaccines Near You

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Or Call 1-800-232-0233



For questions or comments, email the Safer Federal Workforce Task Force at SaferFederalWorkforce@gsa.gov



Testing

Screening Testing

Q: What is screening testing?

A: [Screening tests](#) are intended to identify infection with SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19, in unvaccinated people who are asymptomatic and do not have known, suspected, or reported exposure to SARS-CoV-2. Screening helps to identify unknown cases so that measures can be taken to prevent further transmission. Screening testing is separate and distinct from diagnostic testing, which should be performed on anyone that has signs and symptoms consistent with COVID-19 or following recent known or suspected exposure to SARS-CoV-2.

Q: Should agencies establish a screening testing program for SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19?

A: Yes, agencies should establish a COVID-19 screening testing program by February 15, 2022 for employees who are not fully vaccinated.

An agency generally does not need to include onsite contractor employees or fully vaccinated employees in its screening testing program. For certain roles, functions, or work environments, an agency may determine that it is necessary that certain onsite contractor employees, certain employees regardless of their vaccination status, or certain employees and certain onsite contractor employees regardless of their vaccination status must participate in screening testing, given operational or administrative considerations associated with conducting screening testing for those roles, functions, or work environments.

Q: What testing protocols should be applied through an agency's screening testing program to employees who are not fully vaccinated?

A: When [COVID-19 Community Levels](#) are MEDIUM or HIGH (see FAQs on [Local Conditions](#)), employees who are not fully vaccinated and who work onsite should undergo regular screening testing through their agency's screening testing program. This includes employees who do not work at a Federal facility but who interact in person with members of the public as part of their job duties, such as safety inspectors.

For purposes of regularly testing these employees through a screening testing program, an employee enrolled in the program should be tested weekly for any week during which they work onsite or interact in person with members of the public as part of their job duties. Agencies may require more frequent testing, such as for certain roles, functions, or work environments. Testing may be conducted at a Federal facility or offsite as determined by the agency. The test should not be both self-administered and self-read by the employee unless observed by the agency or an authorized telehealth provider.

Q: Do Federal employees or contractor employees participating in an agency screening testing program need to be able to provide the results of a negative test in order to enter or be present in a Federal facility?

Federal employees participating in an agency screening testing program do not need to be able to provide the results of a negative test each time they enter or are present in their agency's facilities, unless required as part of the agency's screening testing program and workplace safety protocols. That said, Federal employees generally are treated as visitors during a visit to another agency, so while they are onsite at *another* agency's worksite when [COVID-19 Community Levels](#) are MEDIUM or HIGH (see FAQs on [Local Conditions](#)), they should be able to show proof of a negative COVID-19 test result administered within the past 3 days, if they are not fully vaccinated or decline to provide their vaccination information to the host agency.

Similarly, contractor employees participating in an agency testing program do not need to be able to provide the results of a negative test each time they enter or are present at that agency's facilities when [COVID-19 Community Levels](#) are MEDIUM or HIGH (see FAQs on [Local Conditions](#)), unless required as part of the agency's testing program and workplace safety protocols. However, if they are visiting *another* agency's facilities, they should be able to show proof of a negative COVID-19 test result administered within the past 3 days, if they are not fully vaccinated or decline to provide their vaccination information to the host agency.

Q: Do the screening testing protocols apply to employees who are not fully vaccinated and who are not reporting to their worksite (e.g., are on maximum telework, working remotely, or on leave)?

A: No, employees who are working remotely or who are on maximum telework do not need to undergo regular testing. An employee who does not report to a worksite or interact in person with members of the public as part of their job duties during a particular week (e.g., due to taking leave, teleworking, or working remotely) does not need to be tested that week.

Should these employees have a one-time need to report to one of their agency's facilities, they should be tested in the week they are entering the facility when [COVID-19 Community Levels](#) are MEDIUM or HIGH (see FAQs on [Local Conditions](#)). Should these employees need to be onsite at another agency's facility when [COVID-19 Community Levels](#) are MEDIUM or HIGH (see FAQs on [Local Conditions](#)), they generally would be treated as visitors during their visit, and so should be able to show proof of a negative COVID-19 test result administered within the past 3 days.

Q: Do the screening testing protocols apply to Federal employees who are not fully vaccinated and who only work onsite on an infrequent basis?

A: Federal employees who are not fully vaccinated and who work onsite or interact in person with members of the public as part of their job duties on an infrequent basis should be tested at least once in the week that they are working onsite or interact in person with members of the public as part of their job duties. An agency may determine that some employees who generally do not report to a worksite or interact with members of the public as part of their job duties, but may need to do so on an emergency basis (e.g., for accident investigations or disaster response) are required to undergo regular testing when [COVID-19 Community Levels](#) are MEDIUM or HIGH (see FAQs on [Local Conditions](#)), on a frequency determined by the agency.

Should these Federal employees need to be onsite at another agency's facility when [COVID-19 Community Levels](#) are MEDIUM or HIGH (see FAQs on [Local Conditions](#)), they generally would be treated as visitors during their visit, and so would need to be able to show proof of a negative COVID-19 test result administered within the past 3 days.

Q: What types of tests may an agency utilize for a screening testing program?

A: For screening testing programs, agencies may utilize any viral tests [authorized by the Food and Drug Administration](#) (FDA) to detect current infection. There are two types of [viral tests](#): [antigen tests](#) and [nucleic acid application tests \(NAATs\)](#). Reverse transcriptase polymerase chain reaction (RT-PCR) tests are a type of NAAT. Agencies should consult [FDA guidance](#) for specific authorized tests impacted by COVID-19 variants and the current status on recommended use.

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Q: What steps may an agency take if a Federal employee refuses to take a COVID-19 test required pursuant to that program?

A: Refusals to take a required test or to provide the results of the test may result in disciplinary measures. In addition to pursuing any disciplinary action, an agency may separately elect to bar the employee from the agency workplace for the safety of others pending resolution of any disciplinary or other action the agency may pursue. Any decision to bar the employee should occur in consultation with the agency’s onsite security authority, agency’s human resources office, and agency’s legal counsel. In pursuing an adverse action, the agency must also follow normal processes to provide the required notice to the employee.

An agency follows a different process if the employee seeks an accommodation from the requirement to be regularly tested. In that case, an agency should follow its ordinary process to review and consider what, if any, accommodation should be offered in accordance with Federal employment nondiscrimination laws. All agency personnel designated to receive requests for disability accommodations should also know how to handle requests consistent with other Federal employment nondiscrimination laws that may apply. While the request is being resolved, the agency may bar the employee from official worksites. During that temporary period, the agency may direct the employee to work from home. If the employee’s duties cannot be performed via telework, the employee should be granted administrative leave for the temporary period of time while the request is being resolved.

If the employee's request for an accommodation to a testing requirement is denied, and the employee does not comply with the testing requirement, the agency may pursue disciplinary action up to and including removal.

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A: Yes, agencies can utilize [pooled specimen testing](#), assuming the screening testing program utilizes any COVID-19 viral test that is used to detect current infection and has been [authorized by the Food and Drug Administration](#) for use in pooled testing. Agencies should consult [FDA guidance](#) for specific authorized tests impacted by COVID-19 variants and the current status on recommended use.

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A: Yes. When a Federal employee is required to be tested pursuant to an agency's screening testing program, the time the employee spends obtaining the test (including travel time) from a site preapproved by the agency is duty time; thus, there is no need for the employee to take administrative leave for such time during the employee's basic tour of duty. An agency should only authorize an employee to spend time related to screening testing during the employee's basic tour of duty hours and only for the amount of time necessary. Agencies should determine the amount of time to authorize employees to take to travel to the testing site (if travel is required), complete testing, and return to work. Agencies should require employees taking

longer than that amount of time to document the reasons for the additional time. If, due to unforeseen circumstances, the employee is unable to obtain the test during basic tour of duty hours, the normal overtime hours of work rules apply.

Reasonable travel costs that are incurred as a result of obtaining the test from a site preapproved by the agency should be handled the same way as local travel or temporary duty (TDY) cost reimbursement is handled based on agency policy and the Federal Travel Regulation.

When an employee is not required to be tested but decides to obtain a COVID-19 test during basic tour of duty hours at the employee's own initiative, the employee may request sick leave or other available paid time off for that situation.

Q: Are Federal employees and contractor employees participating in an agency screening testing program limited in their ability to work onsite in between tests?

A: No, provided that they have met any applicable testing requirement and have not tested positive for COVID-19, Federal employees and contractor employees participating in an agency screening testing program are not limited in their ability to work onsite between tests, although they should comply with all relevant safety protocols. However, if the employee or contractor employee has come into [close contact](#) with a person with COVID-19 during this time, they should follow CDC guidelines for testing and quarantine, as well as any other requirements set forth in agency workplace safety protocols. Similarly, if they have symptoms consistent with COVID-19, they should follow agency protocols and not enter a worksite.

Agencies should develop a procedure for addressing circumstances in which employees or onsite contractor employees miss their required test, which may include restricting the individual's access to worksites if they have not obtained a test within a period of time specified by the agency.

An employee's failure to comply with testing requirements can result in disciplinary action, up to and including removal. An agency may separately elect to bar the employee from the agency workplace for the safety of others pending resolution of any disciplinary action. A contractor employee's failure to comply with testing requirements may result in that individual being denied entry to a Federal facility. Such circumstances do not relieve the contractor from meeting all contractual requirements.

Testing Results and Information

Testing and Labor Relations

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Testing

Screening Testing

Q: What is screening testing?

A: [Screening testing](#) is intended to identify people with COVID-19 who are asymptomatic or do not have any known, suspected, or reported exposure to SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19. Screening testing helps to identify unknown cases so that measures can be taken to prevent further transmission. Screening testing is separate and distinct from diagnostic testing, which is intended to identify current infection in individuals and is performed when a person has signs or symptoms consistent with COVID-19, or is asymptomatic, but has recent known or suspected exposure to someone with suspected or confirmed SARS-CoV-2 infection.

Examples of screening testing include:

- **Point-in-time screening testing:** This is screening testing that happens on a situational basis, such as before an event or visit.
- **Serial screening testing:** This is screening testing that is repeated at different points in time within a group, such as periodic testing for everyone in a particular setting or facility.

Q: Should agencies establish a COVID-19 serial screening testing program and, if so, for what facilities, settings, roles, or functions?

A: To be consistent with Safer Federal Workforce Task Force guidance, agencies should not implement COVID-19 serial screening testing in other Federal facilities, or for other settings, roles, and functions within Federal facilities, beyond those identified by agencies for high-risk settings, as described below, absent an approved exception from the agency head following consultation with the agency COVID-19 Coordination Team, including the agency Office of General Counsel, and the Safer Federal Workforce Task Force.

CDC [guidance](#) states that, “Screening testing can provide important information to limit transmission and outbreaks in high-risk congregate settings.” Following consultation with the agency COVID-19 Coordination Team, including the agency Office of General Counsel, and the Safer Federal Workforce Task Force, agencies may establish COVID-19 serial screening testing programs for employees (or employees and onsite contractor employees) working in high-risk settings within Federal facilities.

For the purposes of Safer Federal Workforce Task Force guidance, and consistent with CDC guidance, high-risk settings include certain Federal facilities—or certain specific settings within Federal facilities—where (1) COVID-19 transmission risk is high, and (2) the population present onsite is at high risk of severe outcomes from COVID-19 or there is limited access to healthcare. Examples of such settings provided by CDC include, “High-risk congregate settings, such as assisted living facilities, correctional facilities, and homeless shelters, that have demonstrated high potential for rapid and widespread virus transmission to people at high risk for severe illness” and “Settings that involve close quarters and that are isolated from healthcare resources (e.g., fishing vessels, wildland firefighter camps, or offshore oil platforms).”

When an agency has identified potential high-risk settings across its facilities, the agency should consult with the Safer Federal Workforce Task Force to confirm that those settings are high-risk and that establishing a serial screening testing program and/or requiring point-in-time screening testing in those facilities would be consistent with CDC and Safer Federal Workforce Task Force guidance, and should consult with the agency Office of General Counsel on any implementation.

Q: Where an agency has established a COVID-19 serial screening testing program for agency-identified high-risk settings, who should the agency enroll in that program?

A: When an agency has established a serial screening testing program for agency-identified high-risk settings, an agency should enroll all employees working in that setting (which could be a facility, multiple facilities, or certain roles, functions, or settings within those facilities), regardless of vaccination status. When serial screening testing is implemented, agencies must not differentiate among individuals on the basis of their vaccination status, pursuant to Executive Order 13991 and consistent with CDC guidance.

Agencies do not need to include onsite contractor employees in its serial screening testing program(s). For certain settings, roles, or functions, an agency may determine that it is necessary that onsite contractor employees regardless of their vaccination status must participate in serial screening testing, given operational or administrative considerations associated with those particular settings, roles, or functions.

Q: Where an agency has established a COVID-19 serial screening testing program for an agency-identified high-risk setting, what testing protocols should be applied through that program?

A: When [COVID-19 Community Levels](#) are MEDIUM or HIGH, asymptomatic individuals (without a known exposure to someone with COVID-19 within the past 10 days) who are enrolled in a serial screening testing program established for agency-identified high-risk settings, if any, should be tested at least twice weekly for any week during which they work onsite or interact in person with members of the public as part of their job duties in that agency-identified high-risk setting. To be consistent with Safer Federal Workforce Task Force Guidance, agencies should not implement serial screening testing when COVID-19 Community Levels are LOW.

When an agency has established a serial screening testing program for agency-identified high-risk settings, the agency may require more frequent testing than twice weekly, following consultation with the agency's COVID-19 Coordination Team, including the agency Office of General Counsel, and the Safer Federal Workforce Task Force, and provided that agency resources are available to support such increased testing. Testing may be conducted at a Federal facility or offsite as determined by the agency. The test can be both self-administered and self-read by the employee if the agency has the employee certify as to when they took the test and that they received a negative result.

Q: Where Federal agencies have established a COVID-19 serial screening testing program for an agency-identified high-risk setting, do employees or contractor employees participating in that program need to be able to provide the results of a negative test in order to enter or be present in that agency-identified high-risk setting?

A: No. Employees and onsite contractor employees participating in a serial screening testing program for an agency-identified high-risk setting do not need to be able to provide the results of a negative test each time they enter or are present that setting, unless otherwise required as part of the agency's serial screening testing program and workplace safety protocols. This is true regardless of COVID-19 Community Levels.

Q: Where Federal agencies have established a COVID-19 serial screening testing program for an agency-identified high-risk setting, should the serial screening testing protocols apply to employees who are not reporting to their worksite (e.g., are on maximum telework, working remotely, or on leave)?

A: No. Employees who are working remotely or who are on maximum telework do not need to undergo regular screening testing where an agency has established a screening testing program for an agency-identified high-risk setting. An employee who does not report to a

worksite or interact in person with members of the public as part of their job duties during a particular week (e.g., due to taking leave, teleworking, or working remotely) does not need to be tested that week. Should these employees have a one-time need to report to the agency-identified high-risk setting, they should be tested at least twice in the week they are entering the setting when COVID-19 Community Levels are MEDIUM or HIGH.

Q: Where Federal agencies have established a COVID-19 serial screening testing program for an agency-identified high-risk setting, should the screening testing protocols apply to employees who only work onsite on an infrequent basis?

A: Employees who are enrolled in a serial screening testing program established for an agency-identified high-risk setting, and who work onsite or interact in person with members of the public as part of their job duties on an infrequent basis, should be tested at least twice in any week that they are working onsite or interact in person with members of the public as part of their job duties in that agency-identified high-risk setting. An agency may determine that some employees who generally do not report to a worksite or interact with members of the public in that agency-identified high-risk setting as part of their job duties, but who may need to do so on an emergency basis (e.g., for accident investigations or disaster response) are required to undergo serial or point-in-time screening testing when [COVID-19 Community Levels](#) are MEDIUM or HIGH, on a frequency determined by the agency.

Can agencies establish requirements for COVID-19 point-in-time screening testing for onsite contractor employees, visitors, or in-person attendees at agency-hosted meetings, events, or conferences?

A: To be consistent with Safer Federal Workforce Task Force guidance, agencies should not establish COVID-19 [point-in-time screening testing](#) requirements for onsite contractors, visitors, or in-person attendees at agency-hosted meetings, events, or conferences in other settings within Federal facilities beyond agency-identified high-risk settings as described below, absent an exception approved by the agency head only following consultation with the agency COVID-19 Coordination Team, including the agency Office of General Counsel, the Safer Federal Workforce Task Force.

CDC [guidance](#) states that, “Screening testing can provide important information to limit transmission and outbreaks in high-risk congregate settings.” Following consultation with the agency COVID-19 Coordination Team, including the agency Office of General Counsel, and the Safer Federal Workforce Task Force, agencies may establish COVID-19 point-in-time screening testing requirements for onsite contractor employees and visitors accessing high-risk settings within Federal facilities.

For the purposes of Safer Federal Workforce Task Force guidance, and consistent with CDC guidance, high-risk settings include certain Federal facilities—or certain specific settings within Federal facilities—where (1) COVID-19 transmission risk is high, and (2) the population present onsite is at high risk of severe outcomes from COVID-19 or there is limited access to healthcare. Examples of such settings provided by CDC include, “High-risk congregate settings, such as assisted living facilities, correctional facilities, and homeless shelters, that have demonstrated high potential for rapid and widespread virus transmission to people at high risk for severe illness” and “Settings that involve close quarters and that are isolated from healthcare resources (e.g., fishing vessels, wildland firefighter camps, or offshore oil platforms).”

When an agency has identified potential high-risk settings across its facilities, the agency should consult with the Safer Federal Workforce Task Force to confirm that those settings are high-risk and that conducting point-in-time screening testing in those settings and facilities would be consistent with CDC and Safer Federal Workforce Task Force guidance, and should consult with the agency Office of General Counsel prior to implementation.

If an agency has established such requirements for high-risk settings, then when [COVID-19 Community Levels](#) are MEDIUM or HIGH in the county where the Federal facilities with those high-risk settings are located, agencies must require visitors (except those seeking to obtain a public service or benefit), onsite contractor employees (except those individuals otherwise enrolled in an agency serial screening testing program, if any) accessing those settings, as well as in-person attendees at meetings, events, and conferences the agency is hosting in those settings (except those individuals otherwise enrolled in an agency serial screening testing program, if any), regardless of vaccination status, to be able to provide proof that they received a negative test result within 24 hours of accessing that Federal facility or high-risk setting from a viral test authorized by the Food and Drug Administration (FDA) to detect current COVID-19 infection, pursuant to Executive Order 13991 and consistent with CDC guidance.

Q: What types of tests may an agency utilize for COVID-19 serial or point-in-time screening testing?

A: Where agencies are conducting serial or point-in-time screening testing for agency-identified high-risk settings, agencies may utilize any viral tests [authorized by the Food and Drug Administration](#) (FDA) to detect current infection. There are two types of [viral tests](#): antigen tests and nucleic acid amplification tests (NAATs). Reverse transcription polymerase chain reaction (RT-PCR) tests are a type of NAAT. Agencies should consult [FDA guidance](#) for specific authorized tests impacted by COVID-19 variants and the current status on recommended use.

Options for testing methods include: (1) in-store or drive-through point-of-care (POC) testing, such as at pharmacies, (2) swab-testing capabilities that enable an individual to collect the

specimen—using a self-collection kit—and drop it off at a designated collection location or ship it to a laboratory, (3) over-the-counter (OTC) tests, which can be both self-administered and self-read by the employee if the agency has the employee certify as to when they took the test and that they received a negative result, or (4) other self-administered tests, which can be both self-administered and self-read by the employee if the agency has the employee certify as to when they took the test and that they received a negative result.

Agencies must comply with applicable privacy and information collection safeguards and regulations when receiving test results.

Q: What steps may an agency take if a Federal employee refuses to take a COVID-19 test required pursuant to that program?

A: Refusals to take a required test or to provide the results of the test may result in disciplinary measures. In addition to pursuing any disciplinary action, an agency may separately elect to bar the employee from the agency workplace for the safety of others pending resolution of any disciplinary or other action the agency may pursue. Any decision to bar the employee should occur in consultation with the agency's onsite security authority, agency's human resources office, and agency's legal counsel. In pursuing an adverse action, the agency must also follow normal processes to provide the required notice to the employee.

An agency follows a different process if the employee seeks an accommodation from the requirement to be regularly tested. In that case, an agency should follow its ordinary process to review and consider what, if any, accommodation should be offered in accordance with Federal employment nondiscrimination laws. All agency personnel designated to receive requests for disability accommodations should also know how to handle requests consistent with other Federal employment nondiscrimination laws that may apply. While the request is being resolved, the agency may bar the employee from official worksites. During that temporary period, the agency may direct the employee to work from home. If the employee's duties cannot be performed via telework, the employee should be granted administrative leave for the temporary period of time while the request is being resolved.

If the employee's request for an accommodation to a testing requirement is denied, and the employee does not comply with the testing requirement, the agency may pursue disciplinary action up to and including removal.

Q: Do agencies need to pay for the cost of any required COVID-19 serial or point-in-time screening testing for their employees?

A: Yes. Agencies must pay for the cost of serial screening testing of Federal employees pursuant to a screening testing program established for an agency-identified high-risk setting. Agencies must also pay for the cost of any required point-in-time screening testing, including when an employee is required to complete point-in-time screening testing in order to visit another Federal agency's identified high-risk setting or attend an event, meeting, or conference hosted by another Federal agency in a high-risk setting identified by that other agency, if the employee's agency has approved the visit or attendance in advance. Agencies may either pay for the testing directly or reimburse employees for required tests. Should agencies have questions regarding their approach to funding such this testing from agency appropriations, they should contact their agency Office of General Counsel and respective OMB Resource Management Office.

Q: Can agencies utilize pooled specimen testing in a screening testing program?

A: Yes, agencies can utilize [pooled specimen testing](#), assuming the screening testing program utilizes any COVID-19 viral test that is used to detect current infection and has been [authorized by the Food and Drug Administration](#) for use in pooled testing. Agencies should consult [FDA guidance](#) for specific authorized tests impacted by COVID-19 variants and the current status on recommended use.

Pooled specimen testing combines the same type of specimen from several people and conducts one NAAT laboratory test on the combined specimen. If the pooled specimen test returns a positive result, each specimen in the pool must be retested individually. Of note, as the incidence of COVID-19 increases among the population being tested, the cost savings of a pooling strategy decreases because more pooled tests will return positive results, and those specimens will need to be retested individually to determine which individual(s) are positive.

Q: Is required screening testing undertaken on duty time?

A: Yes. When a Federal employee is required to be tested pursuant to an agency's screening testing program, the time the employee spends obtaining the test (including travel time) from a site preapproved by the agency is duty time; thus, there is no need for the employee to take administrative leave for such time during the employee's basic tour of duty. An agency should only authorize an employee to spend time related to screening testing during the employee's basic tour of duty hours and only for the amount of time necessary. Agencies should determine the amount of time to authorize employees to take to travel to the testing site (if travel is required), complete testing, and return to work. Agencies should require employees taking longer than that amount of time to document the reasons for the additional time. If, due to unforeseen circumstances, the employee is unable to obtain the test during basic tour of duty hours, the normal overtime hours of work rules apply.

Reasonable travel costs that are incurred as a result of obtaining the test from a site preapproved by the agency should be handled the same way as local travel or temporary duty (TDY) cost reimbursement is handled based on agency policy and the Federal Travel Regulation.

When an employee is not required to be tested but decides to obtain a COVID-19 test during basic tour of duty hours at the employee's own initiative, the employee may request sick leave or other available paid time off for that situation.

Q: Are employees and contractor employees participating in an agency COVID-19 serial screening testing program for agency-identified high-risk settings limited in their ability to work onsite in between tests?

A: No. Provided that they have met any applicable testing requirement and have not tested positive for COVID-19, employees and contractor employees participating in an agency screening testing program are not limited in their ability to work onsite between tests, although they should comply with all relevant safety protocols. However, if the employee or contractor employee has symptoms consistent with COVID-19, they should follow agency protocols and not enter a worksite.

Agencies should develop a procedure for addressing circumstances in which employees or onsite contractor employees miss their required test, which may include restricting the individual's access to worksites if they have not obtained a test within a period of time specified by the agency.

An employee's failure to comply with testing requirements can result in disciplinary action, up to and including removal. An agency may elect to bar an employee from the agency workplace for the safety of others, including pending resolution of any disciplinary action. Any decision to bar the employee should be made in consultation with the agency's onsite security authority, human resources office, and legal counsel until the agency determines the status the employee should be placed in pending any disciplinary action.

A contractor employee's failure to comply with testing requirements may result in that individual being denied entry to a Federal facility. Such circumstances do not relieve the contractor from meeting all contractual requirements.

Diagnostic Testing

Testing Results and Information

Testing and Labor Relations

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Vaccines Near You

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For questions or comments, email the Safer Federal Workforce Task Force at SaferFederalWorkforce@gsa.gov



Vaccinations

NEW Vaccination Status

Q: Should agencies require employees to be vaccinated or inquire regarding their vaccination status?

A: The Administration strongly encourages all Americans, including Federal employees and contractors, to be vaccinated. Employees should receive paid time off to be vaccinated and to deal with any side effects. At present, COVID-19 vaccination should generally not be a pre-condition for employees or contractors at executive departments and agencies (agencies) to work in-person in Federal buildings, on Federal lands, and in other settings as required by their job duties.

Federal employees and contractors may voluntarily share information about their vaccination status, but agencies should not require federal employees or contractors to disclose such information. Responding to agency inquiries should be voluntary, and agencies should comply with any applicable laws, including requirements under the Privacy Act and the Paperwork Reduction Act, and any applicable collective bargaining obligations. When an employee or contractor voluntarily discloses that they are unvaccinated or declines to provide vaccination information, agencies should use that information to implement CDC-recommended mitigation measures, including masking and physical distancing.

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Vaccinations

Vaccination Status

NEW Q: Should agencies inquire regarding the vaccination status of Federal employees and onsite contractors?

A. Given the different safety protocols for individuals who are fully vaccinated and those who are not fully vaccinated, agencies need to ask about the vaccination status of Federal employees and onsite contractors. Employees and onsite contractors must attest to the truthfulness of the response they provide. If an employee or onsite contractor chooses not to provide a response, they will be treated as unvaccinated for the purpose of agency safety protocols. In requesting this information, agencies should comply with any applicable Federal laws, including requirements under the Privacy Act and the Paperwork Reduction Act, and any applicable collective bargaining obligations. When an employee or contractor discloses that they are unvaccinated or declines to complete the attestation, agencies should treat that individual as not fully vaccinated for purposes of implementing safety measures, including with respect to mask wearing, physical distancing, testing, travel, and quarantine.

NEW Q: Should agencies inquire regarding the vaccination status of visitors to Federal buildings?

A: Visitors to Federal buildings should be asked to provide information about vaccination status. In requesting this information, agencies should comply with any applicable Federal laws, including requirements under the Privacy Act and the Paperwork Reduction Act. Visitors who are not fully vaccinated or who decline to provide information about their vaccination status must provide proof of a negative COVID-19 test from no later than the previous 3 days prior to entry to a Federal building.

These requirements related to the provision of information about vaccination and provision of proof of a recent negative COVID-19 test do not apply to members of the public entering a Federal building or Federal land to obtain a public service or benefit. If they are not fully

vaccinated, these visitors must comply with all relevant CDC guidance, including wearing a mask and physically distancing from other people.

NEW Q: Are agencies required to establish different safety protocols for fully vaccinated and not fully vaccinated individuals?

A: Yes. [Fully vaccinated individuals](#) do not need to physically distance, undergo screening testing, or have restrictions on their official travel (although they still must comply with any local requirements and relevant CDC guidance for fully vaccinated individuals while traveling). Fully vaccinated individuals in areas of substantial or high transmission (see the [CDC COVID-19 Data Tracker County View](#)) need to wear a mask in public indoor settings. Fully vaccinated individuals in areas of low or moderate transmission do not need to wear a mask.

Fully vaccinated individuals might choose to wear a mask regardless of the level of transmission for a variety of reasons.

Individuals who are not fully vaccinated or who decline to provide information about their vaccination status must wear masks regardless of community transmission level, physically distance, and undergo screening testing weekly or twice-weekly, and their official travel is restricted.

In order to be treated as fully vaccinated pursuant to agency COVID-19 workplace safety plans and protocols, employees and onsite contractors must attest that they are fully vaccinated by signing a form provided by the agency. Visitors also will be asked to provide information about their vaccination status. Individuals who decline to provide information on their vaccination status will be treated as not fully vaccinated for purposes of agency COVID-19 workplace safety plans and protocols. Visitors who are not fully vaccinated must provide proof of a negative COVID-19 test that occurred within the previous 3 days prior to entry to a Federal building.

Individuals entering a Federal building or Federal land to obtain a public service or benefit do not need to provide information about their vaccination status or provide proof of a negative COVID-19 test. If they are not fully vaccinated, they must comply with all relevant CDC guidance, including wearing a mask.

NEW Q: What safety protocols should an agency apply to employees and onsite contractors prior to establishing a means of determining vaccination status consistent with this guidance?

A: Agencies may take a reasonable period of time to establish a program for determining the vaccination status of employees and onsite contractors consistent with this guidance. Prior to

an agency establishing such a program, they should continue to utilize their current means of determining the safety protocols that apply to specific employees and contractors.

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Vaccinations

Vaccination Status

UPDATED Q: Who is considered fully vaccinated?

A: People are considered [fully vaccinated](#) for COVID-19 ≥ 2 weeks after they have received the second dose in a 2-dose series (Pfizer-BioNTech or Moderna), or ≥ 2 weeks after they have received a single-dose vaccine (Johnson and Johnson (J&J)/Janssen). There is currently no post-vaccination time limit on fully vaccinated status.

This guidance applies to COVID-19 vaccines currently either approved or authorized for emergency use by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration (Pfizer-BioNTech, Moderna, and Johnson & Johnson [J&J]/Janssen COVID-19 vaccines). This guidance can also be applied to COVID-19 vaccines that have been listed for emergency use by the World Health Organization (e.g., AstraZeneca/Oxford). More information is available at [Interim Clinical Considerations for Use of COVID-19 Vaccines](#) | CDC.

Q: Should agencies inquire regarding the vaccination status of federal employees and onsite contractors?

A: Given the different safety protocols for individuals who are fully vaccinated and those who are not fully vaccinated, agencies need to ask about the vaccination status of federal employees and onsite contractors. Employees and onsite contractors must attest to the truthfulness of the response they provide. If an employee or onsite contractor chooses not to provide a response, they will be treated as unvaccinated for the purpose of agency safety protocols. In requesting this information, agencies should comply with any applicable federal laws, including requirements under the Privacy Act and the Paperwork Reduction Act, and any applicable collective bargaining obligations. When an employee or contractor discloses that they are unvaccinated or declines to complete the attestation, agencies should treat that individual as not fully vaccinated for purposes of implementing safety measures, including with respect to mask wearing, physical distancing, testing, travel, and quarantine.

Q: Should agencies inquire regarding the vaccination status of visitors to federal buildings?

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These requirements related to the provision of information about vaccination and provision of proof of a recent negative COVID-19 test do not apply to members of the public entering a federal building or federal land to obtain a public service or benefit. If they are not fully vaccinated, these visitors must comply with all relevant CDC guidance, including wearing a mask and physically distancing from other people.

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A: Yes. [Fully vaccinated individuals](#) do not need to physically distance, undergo screening testing, or have restrictions on their official travel (although they still must comply with any local requirements and relevant CDC guidance for fully vaccinated individuals while traveling). Fully vaccinated individuals in areas of substantial or high transmission (see the [CDC COVID-19 Data Tracker County View](#)) need to wear a mask in public indoor settings. Fully vaccinated individuals in areas of low or moderate transmission do not need to wear a mask.

Fully vaccinated individuals might choose to wear a mask regardless of the level of transmission for a variety of reasons.

Individuals who are not fully vaccinated or who decline to provide information about their vaccination status must wear masks regardless of community transmission level, physically distance, and undergo screening testing weekly or twice-weekly, and their official travel is restricted.

In order to be treated as fully vaccinated pursuant to agency COVID-19 workplace safety plans and protocols, employees and onsite contractors must attest that they are fully vaccinated by signing a form provided by the agency. Visitors also will be asked to provide information about their vaccination status. Individuals who decline to provide information on their vaccination status will be treated as not fully vaccinated for purposes of agency COVID-19 workplace safety

plans and protocols. Visitors who are not fully vaccinated must provide proof of a negative COVID-19 test that occurred within the previous 3 days prior to entry to a federal building.

Individuals entering a federal building or federal land to obtain a public service or benefit do not need to provide information about their vaccination status or provide proof of a negative COVID-19 test. If they are not fully vaccinated, they must comply with all relevant CDC guidance, including wearing a mask.

Q: What safety protocols should an agency apply to employees and onsite contractors prior to establishing a means of determining vaccination status consistent with this guidance?

A: Agencies may take a reasonable period of time to establish a program for determining the vaccination status of employees and onsite contractors consistent with this guidance. Prior to an agency establishing such a program, they should continue to utilize their current means of determining the safety protocols that apply to specific employees and contractors.

NEW Q: How should an agency ask employees about their vaccination status?

A: Agencies should ask employees to complete the [Certification of Vaccination form](#) (“form” or “disclosure form”). By completing the form, employees will provide information about their vaccination status and attest to the truthfulness of that information. Individuals who do not complete the form will be treated as not fully vaccinated for purposes of agency safety protocols.

The Safer Federal Workforce Task Force has produced a [template email](#) that agencies should use as a means for contacting employees and distributing the Certification of Vaccination form. For purposes of this email, an “employee” means an employee of the agency, including a current civilian federal employee or a member of the uniformed services (including a reservist or member of the National Guard on active duty). For those employees who do not have access to email, agencies should determine the best method of distribution.

Agencies are able to maintain these employee disclosures, under the authorities of the Office of Personnel Management’s regulations for employee medical files (5 C.F.R. part 293 subpart E) and OPM/GOVT-10, Employee Medical File System of Records, 75 Fed. Reg. 35099 (June 21, 2010), amended 80 Fed. Reg. 74815 (Nov. 30, 2015). Agencies that are not subject to OPM’s regulations (or who employ categories of employees not covered by OPM/GOVT-10) must give their employees an alternative Privacy Act statement.

Please note that contractors and visitors will also be asked, under most circumstances, to fill out the Certification of Vaccination form – however, agencies **should not be** collecting and

maintaining contractor and visitor disclosures at this time unless an agency has a system of records notice that covers its collection of this information. Please see below for more information concerning visitors and contractors.

NEW Q: How should an agency ask onsite contractors about their vaccination status?

A: Agencies should provide onsite contractors with the [Certification of Vaccination form](#) when they enter a federal building or federally controlled indoor worksite.

Unless an agency has an existing system of records notice that permits it to collect and maintain this information on its contractors, agencies will direct onsite contractors to complete the Certification of Vaccination form and keep it with them during their time on federal premises—they may be asked to show the form upon entry to a federal building or federally controlled indoor worksite and to a federal employee who oversees their work. Onsite contractors who are not fully vaccinated (or who decline to disclose vaccination status) will either be enrolled in the agency’s testing program or required to show proof of a negative COVID-19 test result from within the previous 3 days before entry to a federal building or federally controlled indoor worksite.

Agencies may email the form to contractors in advance of their time on-site or utilize a unique tool or application to share the form with contractors and enable them to easily complete it, but the agency will not maintain Certification of Vaccination forms from contractors at this time unless an agency has a system of records notice that covers its collection of this information from onsite contractors. Any such collection, storage, or maintenance of the attestation disclosure forms may implicate the Privacy Act and Paperwork Reduction Act.

If authorized and consistent with the terms of the contract, an agency may work with a contracting company to facilitate compliance by its onsite employees with the agency’s safety protocols, such as by having the company certify that all onsite contractors are fully vaccinated.

NEW Q: How should an agency ask visitors about their vaccination status?

A: Agencies should provide visitors with the [Certification of Vaccination form](#) when they enter a federal building or federally controlled indoor worksite. Unless an agency has an existing system of records notice that permits it to collect and maintain this information on visitors, agencies will direct visitors to complete the Certification of Vaccination form and keep it with them during their time on federal premises—visitors may be asked to show the form upon entry to a federal building or federally controlled indoor worksite. If they are not fully

vaccinated or decline to answer, they will be required to show a negative COVID-19 test result from within the previous three days.

Agencies may email the Certification of Vaccination form to visitors in advance of arrival or utilize a tool or application to share the form with visitors and enable visitors to easily complete it, but the agency will not maintain Certification of Vaccination forms from visitors unless an agency has a system of records notice that covers its collection of this information from visitors. Any such collection, storage, or maintenance of the attestation disclosure forms may implicate the Privacy Act and Paperwork Reduction Act.

Individuals entering a federal building, federally controlled indoor worksite, or federal land to obtain a public service or benefit do not need to complete the form or show documentation of a negative COVID-19 test result. However, if they are not fully vaccinated, they must comply with all relevant CDC guidance and safety protocols, including mask-wearing and physical distancing requirements.

NEW Q: Should agencies request documentation to verify an employee's vaccination status?

A: Agencies should not request documentation to verify an employee's vaccination status. If the agency receives a good faith allegation that strongly suggests that an employee made a false statement on the Certification of Vaccination form, the agency may request documentation as part of its investigation into the alleged false statement. If an employee who has attested to being vaccinated exhibits symptoms of COVID-19 illness, the agency should apply its safety protocols, but this is not an appropriate reason to request documentation to verify an employee's vaccination status.

NEW Q: What if an employee is not vaccinated due to a medical or religious reason?

A: Employees who are not vaccinated due to medical or religious reasons should check either "I have not been vaccinated" or "I decline to respond" on the Certification of Vaccination form and must follow the safety protocols in place for not fully vaccinated persons. After submitting the form, they may then use the agency's established reasonable accommodations process to seek an accommodation, if necessary, related to agency safety protocols or procedures.

NEW Q: Are there penalties for providing false information on the vaccination attestation form?

A: Federal employees who make a false statement on the Certification of Vaccination form could be subject to an adverse personnel action, up to and including removal from their position. It is also a federal crime (18 U.S.C. § 1001) for anyone to provide false information on

the form. Falsification could also affect continuing eligibility for access to classified information or for employment in a national security position under applicable adjudicative guidelines.

Declining to answer—including selecting “I decline to respond” on the Certification of Vaccination form—does not constitute providing false information.

NEW Q: If an agency already has information on an employee’s vaccination status, do they need to utilize the form?

A: In some cases, agencies may have information on the vaccination status of certain employees—for example, if the agency administered the vaccine to that employee. Where the agency already has the requisite information regarding vaccination status, it can utilize that information for purposes of determining the proper safety protocols to apply to that individual, consistent with the requirements of the Privacy Act. An agency is not required to collect duplicative information through the Certification of Vaccination form, if not necessary. However, if an agency has not collected this information from employees, it should use the Certification of Vaccination form to do so.

NEW Q: Which individuals within an agency should have access to information on employees’ vaccination status?

A: The Privacy Act permits disclosure within the agency to employees “who have a need for the record in the performance of their duties.” 5 U.S.C. 552a(b)(1). Agencies should only disseminate information to the appropriate agency officials who have a need to know to ensure effective implementation of the safety protocols, which, in many cases, will include the supervisor level. Agencies must comply with the requirements of the Privacy Act at all times. Agencies should consult with their Senior Agency Official for Privacy on any questions related to Privacy Act requirements.

NEW Q: How should an agency maintain this employee information once it is received?

A: Agencies have unique operational environments and may develop their own processes to maintain submissions of Certification of Vaccination forms in compliance with all applicable laws and in accordance with their agency’s records management policies. Agencies may also develop and utilize tools and applications to maintain submissions of disclosure forms.

The Certification of Vaccination form’s Privacy Act statement refers to the Government-wide system of records (OPM/GOVT-10) for employee medical files (EMFs), which is governed by OPM regulations (5 C.F.R. part 293, subpart E). Under those rules, each agency must have written instructions for its EMF system with appropriate safeguards. Agencies that are not subject to OPM’s regulations (or who employ categories of employees not covered by OPM/GOVT-10)

must give their employees an alternative Privacy Act statement. As a general rule, this information should not be maintained in the Official Personnel Folder.

Agencies are encouraged to take steps to promote privacy and IT security, while also providing the relevant information to those who need to know in order to implement the safety protocols. Agencies should consult with their Agency Records Officer, Chief Information Officer, and Senior Agency Official for Privacy to determine the best means to maintain this information to meet the agency's needs.

NEW Q: Should agencies provide a means for individuals to update their vaccination status?

A: Yes. Employees should submit a new [Certification of Vaccination form](#) when their vaccination status changes.

NEW Q: Should supervisors collect information on vaccination status directly from employees?

A: Agencies should ask employees to complete the [Certification of Vaccination form](#) and should designate the appropriate agency official to whom the completed form should be submitted.

NEW Q: What type of negative COVID-19 test result must a visitor or onsite contractor who is not fully vaccinated show documentation of in order to enter a federal building?

A: Agencies may determine what types of tests a visitor or onsite contractor can show documentation of in order to enter a federal building, provided that the tests are authorized by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration and produce a dated result. Note that an onsite contractor enrolled in an agency testing program does not need to show a recent negative COVID-19 test result.

NEW Q: Do agencies need to ask employees on maximum telework or remote workers about their vaccination status?

A: Yes, agencies should provide the [Certification of Vaccination form](#) to all employees, including employees on maximum telework and [remote workers](#).

NEW Q: If an agency has a system of records notice that covers its collection of information on vaccination status from onsite contractors or visitors, can the agency collect that information?

A: Yes, if an agency has a system of records notice that covers its collection of the requisite information—as reflected in the [Certification of Vaccination form](#)—from onsite contractors or

visitors consistent with the Privacy Act, it may do so. The agency should ensure such a collection is also consistent with the Paperwork Reduction Act.

NEW Q: If a federal employee seeks to enter space under the control of another agency, must they complete a Certification of Vaccination form at that agency?

A: Yes, federal employees are treated as visitors during their visit to another agency, meaning they would need to complete a [Certification of Vaccination form](#) and, if they are not fully vaccinated or decline to disclose their status, they would need to show proof of a negative COVID-19 test result within the past 3 days. As with other visitors, the employee should keep the form with them during their time onsite at the other agency.



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